

Reddy Reckoner

The Bellary brothers have got a sizeable chunk of the pie even as t



➊ Rural development and panchayat raj minister and Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa's close aide Shobha Karandlaje removed within hours of the tenuous truce brokered by BJP leader Sushma Swaraj in Delhi.

➋ Yeddyurappa's principal secretary V.P. Baligar transferred and in his place comes I.S.N. Prasad, the third Telugu-speaking officer in the chief minister's office.

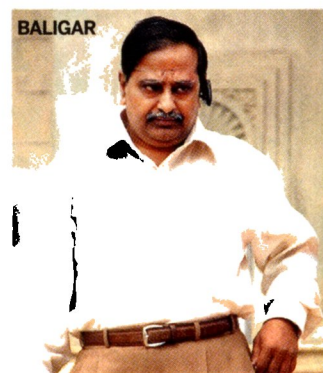
➌ Speaker and Lingayat leader Jagadish Shettar will

join the Cabinet soon even though the Reddys wanted Shettar to replace Yeddyurappa. One of Yeddyurappa's men V.H. Kageri or C.M. Udasi may replace Shettar soon.

➍ The reinstatement of key IAS and IPS officials bundled out by Yeddyurappa shows clear capitulation by the chief minister to the demands of Reddy brothers. Yeddyurappa will have to adopt a hands-off policy regarding the mining areas where the Reddy brothers operate.

➎ Reddy supporters to be put in charge of key

districts, including Raichur, Bellary, Koppal, Haveri, Gadag, Davanagere and Karwar. Independents who were roped in by the Reddys to prop up the first BJP Government last year will be rewarded with this extra assignment.



leaders like Arun Jaitley, Ananth Kumar or Swaraj to play a key role on the national map these leaders from Karnataka may want to look inwards and play a bigger role in the state. Yeddyurappa will, in that case, be forced to skate on thin ice.

If push comes to shove, the Reddy brothers may not even hesitate to float their own regional party so that they can keep their options open just in case new Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister K. Rosaiah tightens the screws on their mega empire operating from the border areas. In the game of one-upmanship, the late YSR's son and Kadapah MP Jaganmohan Reddy, who shuttles between the Karnataka capital and his home base in Andhra Pradesh, has already publicly announced that he will fulfil his late father's dream of sending the largest number of MPs from Andhra Pradesh. Not only is it a message of support to the future

Congress prime minister, but also a reflection of the immense support that Jaganmohan will derive from the Reddy brothers who had always considered YSR part of their family.

In their understanding of politics it is business first. Having honed their skills in the school of business and now

the school of politics—their tough negotiating skills already yielding so many bargains—it is going to take Yeddyurappa supernatural powers to get the Reddy tiger off his back.

With a 10-day session of the state Assembly set to begin from December 10, Yeddyurappa can kiss and make up with the enemy and toe their line or just shoot his mouth off against the Reddys directly or indirectly and get ejected from the chief minister's chair. His ability to work round the clock, tour the districts and emerge as a party mascot may not be of much use if he cannot take everybody along.

One of the best things that Yeddyurappa has done is in bringing no-nonsense but people-friendly IAS officer S.V. Ranganath from the Space Department in the chief secretary's post. It was Ranganath's personal contacts in the Centre that helped the state get early flood relief. A soft-spoken

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